



International Congress on Love and Sex with Robots – Yeah, that's a thing!

Another aspect that we are forced to consider is fetishes and the depravity of modern society. We're not going to beat around the bush here, we're sure that you have encountered and probably enjoyed pornography online. We're also sure that you have some fetishes, and some kinds of porn that you like. We're also reasonably confident that you have come across some absolutely bonkers videos that either disgust you or make you sit up and shout, "Seriously, what the hell is wrong with this world?"

The problem with having over seven billion people on the planet is that you get some really crazy fetishes, which makes it harder for those people to find willing partners. Bots are one way of solving that problem. But are they the right way?

ETHICS

The International Congress for Love and Sex with Robots held their annual event in December 2016. We didn't attend, but we can recreate the questions that are on the top of everyone's mind. Since bots will be in contact with many humans, they will affect and perhaps alter society. Shouldn't we have policy and regulations?

A very uncomfortable and enraging example would be regarding paedophiles. As much as we detest the idea ourselves, we have to ask, would it be better or worse to make a child bot? Would that encourage and validate the disgusting and immoral fetish? Would it help prevent paedophiles from acting on their urges, and thus, help prevent real children from becoming victims?

What about the overall message we would send even using regular bots?

We obviously expect most bots to cater to heterosexual men, so what does it say about us as a society where the bot that men want is a submissive woman who is literally just meat to them? Well silicone, technically, but you get the drift. How do we even know if the powers that be have our best interests at heart? With huge profits to be made, will anyone want to pass up big business just to be "moral"? Will banning it even work? Drugs are illegal, and punishable with heavy sentences, and yet you see drugs being used openly at parties, and we all have friends who we

an individual level. When sexbots do arrive, how will you react to them?

Sexbots could pose a threat similar to drugs. We're not being sensational here, we're serious. Just like drugs, sex too is done for pleasure. Anything that is done for pleasure can get addictive, and there is scope for abuse. Drinking, smoking, Facebook... anything that gives us pleasure is already addictive... So when there is instantaneous access to what is arguably the most pleasurable act of all, are we really going to doubt that it would be addictive to many? In moderation the act is good exercise, but overdoing anything is bad, and getting hooked on something usually spells disaster for productivity.

There are advantages too, which we shouldn't ignore. For one, people who might be frustrated with the lack of sex would not have to be anymore. It could bring about real positive change in their lives. In such a case, it could actually boost productivity! Then there's the biggest advantage of all – safe sex! Unless you're sharing them (*yuck*) bots might be the safest sex you can possibly have. Without the risk of pregnancy and disease, you could just focus on enjoying yourself

HUM

The first ever AI infused and arduino-hackable sex toy on the market, the Hum is said to be a complete reimagining of what a toy could be. From the 3D printed internal structure, to the custom circuitry and pressure sensors, to thousands of lines of sophisticated computer code, it seems like the quintessential raunchy geek toy. So what's AI about it? The creators say it's designed to respond to the users rhythm and subliminal inputs. So if you speed up so will it and vice versa. As for the Arduino hackable part well if you want to get your hands dirty (in code, you pervs) you can, because it's based on the open-source Arduino standard for microcontrollers.



Rugged but understanding of your needs

know for a fact use banned substances occasionally. We will find a way to get what we want.

IMPLICATIONS

However, let's also not get ahead of ourselves. Before we worry about all of mankind, let's consider the effects on

– rare in this day and age. Would this actually also contribute significantly to reducing sexual crime? Sure, the majority of Indians wouldn't be able to afford a bot, but those who could would be a more satisfied bunch, and this should reduce the sexual crimes